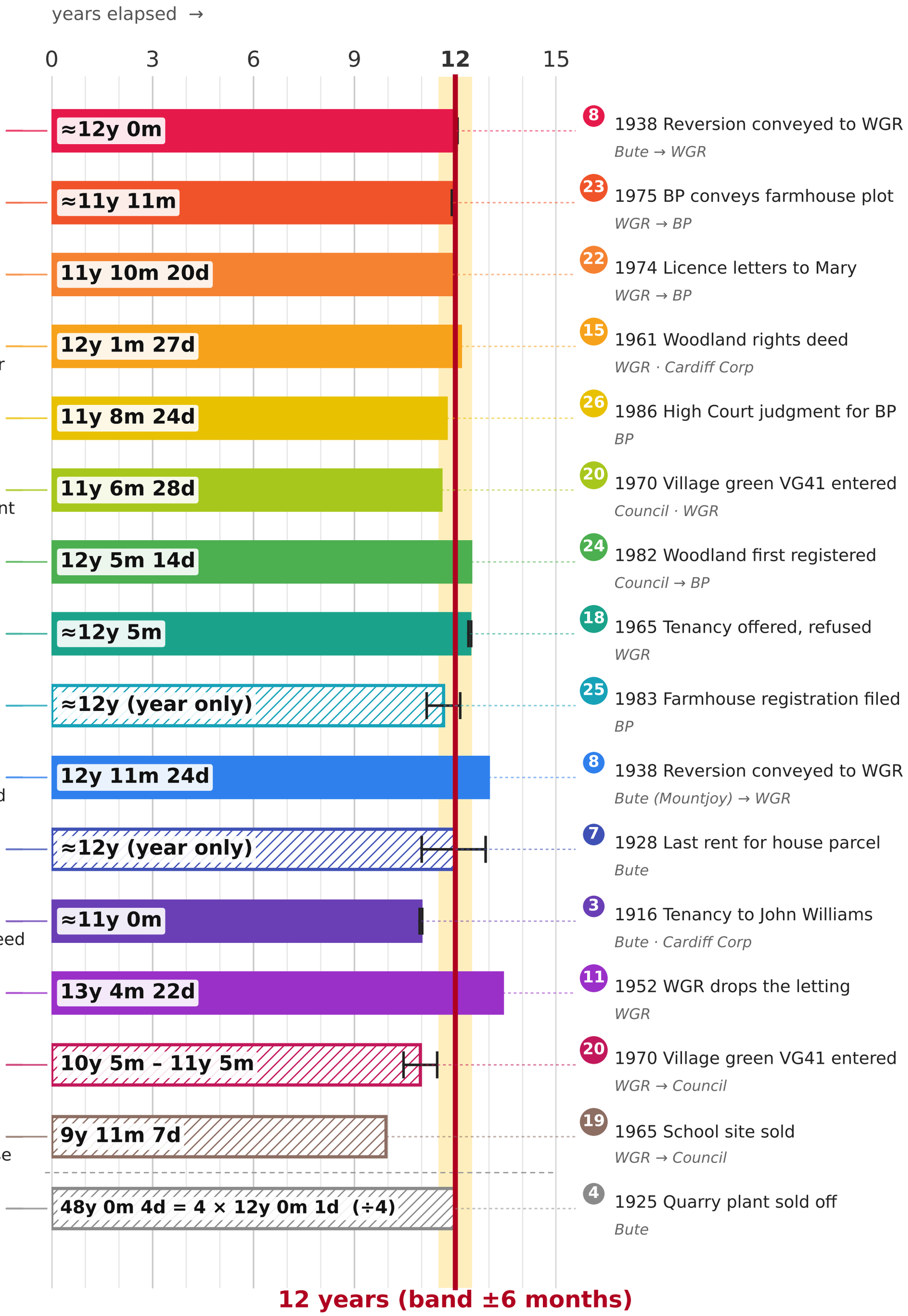
The twelve-year pattern — Cedfin / Tŷ Mawr lands

Llandough-juxta-Penarth and Leckwith. Every bar starts at 0; its length is the real gap between two dated events on the same holding, in years. Bars are sorted by closeness to 12 years. Numbers match the notes.



How to read it

Solid bar: both dates from records (1987 judgment, registers, archives, press).

Hatched bar: one end rests on Mary Williams's account, a year only, or an unverified parcel link.

Black whisker: the range when a month or day is unknown; the bar shows the middle.

Grey bar: 1877 → 1925 is 48 years, drawn at a quarter of its length to show it as 4 × 12.

Who acted (grey italic under each end note):

Bute = Bute estate, incl. Mountjoy Ltd · Cardiff Corp = Cardiff County Borough / City Corporation

WGR = Western Ground Rents Ltd · Council = Glamorgan County Council, Penarth UDC

BP = BP Pension Trust / BP Properties Ltd · War Ag, Air Ministry: no taking of this land found on file

Pattern chart for discussion; dates from the cited records; not a finding of any court.

Notes to the twelve-year chart

Each number matches a callout on the chart. J = BP Properties Ltd v Buckler [1987] EWCA Civ 2.
EV = our evidence catalogue. Tags in brackets mark what is not checked against a primary record.

1 — 1877 — Bute–Thomas deal (reported) (unverified)

Mary Williams's later account dates a Bute agreement (sale or quarry lease of the house parcel) with Daniel Thomas & Son to 6 Nov 1877. The instrument has not been found; the 6 Nov 1877 lease photographed at Glamorgan Archives is a Clyde Street, Roath building lease, not the farm.

Source: EV-0006, EV-0008 (Mary Williams's account); EV-0213 (the Roath lease)

2 — 1905 — Bute–Cardiff Corporation strip deed (purpose inferred)

23 Feb 1905: Bute conveys rights over a strip of what is now the woodland title to Cardiff County Borough. It is very probably the sewer/pumping-station easement Cardiff paid for; the deed itself is unread.

Source: WA735527 Charges entry 1 (register view 18 Sep 2026); EV-0013; cycle-038 report

3 — 1916 — Tenancy to John Williams

Feb 1916: a yearly tenancy of "the whole of the farm" to John Williams from "the Marquis". This is the first record that puts the family's occupation on a tenancy footing.

Source: 1987 judgment; EV-0014 (deed not held)

4 — 1925 — Quarry plant sold off

10 Nov 1925: the Llandough quarry / lime works plant is catalogued and sold (Lewis & Pritchard's "surplus plant at Llandough" was sold Aug 1925). The quarry leaving is the end point of the 1877 bar.

Source: Glamorgan Archives DSA/12/4888 (catalogue only); London Gazette 29 Oct 1926 p.7040

5 — 1926 — Copyhold ends; Mountjoy formed

1 Jan 1926: Law of Property Act 1922 s.128 turns all copyhold into freehold; the 1925 property Acts come into force. The same year Bute's remaining property is put into Mountjoy Ltd, the company that sold to WGR in 1938 (month of incorporation unverified). Llandough Rectory, beside "part of the Bute Estate", is sold 7 Oct 1926.

Source: LPA 1922 ss.128, 138; TNA catalogue GB 0214 DB (F043); Glamorgan Archives DSA/12/5085 (catalogue)

6 — 1926 — Bute lets Lewis Road land (parcel unverified)

Dec 1926: Bute lets land near Lewis Road, Llandough, to Penarth Urban District Council. Catalogue entry only; the plan has not been matched to farm fields.

Source: Glamorgan Archives DBDT123/6 (catalogue only)

7 — 1928 — Last rent for house parcel (unverified)

1928 is the year Mary Williams reported as the last rent paid for the house parcel. It rests on her account only; no rent book is on file.

Source: EV-0016 (Mary Williams's account; not held)

8 — 1938 — Reversion conveyed to WGR

25 Dec 1938 (completion reported 23 Dec): Mountjoy Ltd, for Bute, conveys the reversion of the farm to Western Ground Rents Ltd. The deed is unread, so whether it covered Parcel B is not known; the 1965 school sale uses it as root of title.

Source: 1987 judgment; EV-0022 (press); EV-0216 (Vale FOI 00211027)

9 — 1939 — Parcel B monthly letting

18 May 1939: WGR lets 5.30 acres (Parcel B) beside Ty-Mawr farmhouse to John Williams, then about 72, monthly at 8s, "reserving quarrying rights". While a tenancy runs, the tenant's years do not count against the landlord.

Source: Glamorgan Archives DBDT/123/7; EV-0023; archive reply ref 2026/4439

10 — 1949 — Surrender & regrant to F. Buckler

2 Feb 1949: John Williams's tenancy is surrendered after arrears and an unwritten yearly tenancy is granted to Frederick Buckler.

Source: 1987 judgment; EV-0025

11 — 1952 — WGR drops the letting

10 Oct 1952: WGR's agents write that they "did not propose to proceed with the letting to Mr Frederick Buckler". Last rent follows in 1953, under a judgment for arrears.

Source: 1987 judgment

12 — 1955 — Farm repossessed, not farmhouse

4 Jul 1955: a High Court possession order is enforced on all the farm except the farmhouse and garden (notice to quit expired 2 Feb 1955).

Source: 1987 judgment

13 — 1958 — "A Welsh Crichel Down" complaint

19 Nov 1958: Mrs M. D. Buckler tells Glamorgan County Council's planning committee the land was "wrongfully appropriated" by Glamorgan CC, Penarth UDC, Cardiff RDC and WGR. Same year: Leckwith Common inquiry 6 May (she claimed grazing rights) and the Cardiff (Leckwith Common) CPO 1957 confirmed 8 Sep; no petition was lodged.

Source: EV-0037 (Western Mail 20 Nov 1958 p.7, OCR); EV-0035; EV-0038; TNA BD 11/3775 (unread)

14 — 1959 — Tenancy offer refused (month unknown)

1959 (month unknown): WGR offers Mary a tenancy of the farmhouse and garden; she refuses and claims title through her grandfather.

Source: 1987 judgment; EV-0039

15 — 1961 — Woodland rights deed

29 Mar 1961: deed between WGR, South Western Brick & Tile Co. and Cardiff City Corporation giving rights over the "pink" land now in the woodland title. Rights, not a transfer; the deed is not held.

Source: WA735527 Charges entry 3; EV-0040

16 — 1962 — Possession order, farmhouse

11 Dec 1962: Cardiff County Court possession order (farmhouse and garden) and mesne profits, WGR v Frederick and Mary Buckler. An order like this could be enforced for 12 years.

Source: 1987 judgment

17 — 1963 — Suspended committal order (day unknown)

Jun 1963: suspended committal order over the mesne profits.

Source: 1987 judgment

18 — 1965 — Tenancy offered, refused (day unknown)

Mar 1965: a weekly tenancy is offered to "Mrs Williams" and refused. BP later admitted Mary was in adverse possession from 1965–67.

Source: 1987 judgment

19 — 1965 — School site sold (parcel link unverified)

11 Jun 1965: WGR with Lakeside & Llandough Development Co sells the Llandough primary school site; root of title the 25 Dec 1938 conveyance. Whether the site lay in the fields repossessed in 1955 is not shown on file.

Source: Vale of Glamorgan FOI 00211027 (EV-0216); F027

20 — 1970 — Village green VG41 entered (sheet unread)

16 Jun 1970: VG41 registered under the Commons Registration Act 1965, Glamorgan County Council as registration authority, on what the wiki maps as the south-east ground of Parcel A. Notice was public only; the objection window closed in 1972.

Source: EV-0044 (wiki date; register sheet unread)

21 — 1971 — Abstract of title for BP (year only)

1971: abstract of title prepared for BP Pension Trust (recited only).

Source: EV-0045

22 — 1974 — Licence letters to Mary

31 Oct 1974: two letters from BP Properties grant Mary a rent-free licence; the warrant is withdrawn before 25 Nov. Leave to enforce the 1962 order had been obtained on 19 Sep 1974 (11y 9m 8d after it), 41 days before the 12 years ran out.

Source: 1987 judgment; reopen-loop ground R4

23 — 1975 — BP conveys farmhouse plot

23 May 1975: BP Pension Trust conveys the farmhouse plot and other land to BP Properties, keeping the rest as "Retained Land"; six months before the Vale became a compulsory registration area.

Source: WA735527 Charges entries 4–5; reopen-loop ground R10

24 — 1982 — Woodland first registered

30 Nov 1982: Linklaters & Paines apply for first registration of WA231076 for BP Properties, after a 19 Nov 1982 conveyance.

Source: HM Land Registry letter 23 Mar 2026

25 — 1983 — Farmhouse registration filed

23 Feb 1983: application for WA240304 (farmhouse). Mary Williams dies 26 Mar 1983; Linklaters–HMLR correspondence follows 8 Apr 1983.

Source: HM Land Registry letter 23 Mar 2026; reopen-loop ground R3

26 — 1986 — High Court judgment for BP

24 Jul 1986: Hollis J decides for BP Properties; the Court of Appeal dismisses the appeal on 31 Jul 1987.

Source: 1987 judgment

Pattern chart for discussion; dates from the cited records; not a finding of any court.